

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR
PRESENTENCE REPORT**

**SEALED SYNTHETIC TWIN — FICTIONAL WORKBENCH
PROJECTION ONLY; NOT A REAL PSR OR CM/ECF RECORD**

Sealed Presentence Report Packet — Draft January 9 and Final February 17

**United States District Court for the Middle District of North Carolina United States v.
Mateo Serrano** Criminal Action No. SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328 Sealed Volume PSR-SV-1
Finalized February 17, 2026

This sealed synthetic packet consolidates the January 9 draft and February 17 final presentence report prepared by fictional Probation Officer Niko Faye. It contains invented facts and inert labels only. It is paired page-for-page with public Docket Entry 32, which is a category surrogate rather than a redacted copy.

Distribution is limited within the exercise to the court, Serrano through Celia Arden, and the fictional United States through Bram Ives. Nothing here represents a real probation record or confers access to PACER or CM/ECF. The packet omits addresses, birth data, credentials, account numbers, treatment providers, and usable transaction mechanics.

The draft supplied the January objection baseline. The final reflects the probation officer's review of submissions while preserving the unresolved § 3B1.1(b) dispute for Judge Elara Venn. Any authorized workbench display must remain tied to the exact disclosure and pack identity and must end when the synthetic grant is revoked.

Version Note and Revision Control

The draft was provided through counsel on January 9, 2026. Serrano objected on January 23 to the proposed aggravating-role adjustment. Probation issued a written position on January 30, and the government responded on February 6. The final report dated February 17 retains the adjustment and labels the objection unresolved for sentencing.

The consolidated presentation does not reproduce two complete reports. Instead, each subject states the final account and, where necessary, identifies whether the draft differed. Changes unrelated to the role dispute are administrative and do not alter the public plea facts. The final remains the controlling probation version for the hearing.

Niko Faye certifies that all names and facts are synthetic and that confidential distribution in this training record follows the court's rule-based presentence process. This page records version lineage, not a public filing event. The paired public position identifies only dates and relationship between versions, and cannot be used to reconstruct the sealed narrative.

Case and Offense Overview

Serrano pleaded guilty on November 18, 2025, to Count One, conspiracy to commit wire fraud under 18 U.S.C. §§ 1349 and 1343. The fictional offense involved false reimbursement claims made against Meridian Community Supply Cooperative for services that were not performed. The stipulated period ran from August 4 through November 2, 2025.

The packet treats the plea agreement, factual basis, and Rule 11 transcript as the governing public sources for admitted facts. It does not treat the guilty plea as an admission that Serrano exercised managerial authority. Exactly five persons were criminally responsible, but relative role remains disputed.

All narrative is deliberately abstract. There is no form template, approval workflow, account route, credential, message endpoint, concealment technique, or instruction capable of facilitating a real offense. Names of the fictional participants are retained because they are already part of the public stipulation. Any further relationship is described with inert exercise labels rather than personal data.

Fact-Aster — Offense Conduct

The adopted account states that Serrano knowingly joined Alina Pared, Corin Bell, Darius Venn, and Nessa Holt in seeking payment on false representations that eligible services had occurred. Serrano understood that the cooperative would evaluate those representations and intended the group to receive funds to which it was not entitled.

Fact-Aster describes Serrano as participating in planning discussions, confirming that certain claims would be included, and communicating with other members about completion status. The report does not state how a claim was technically prepared, transmitted, authenticated, reviewed, or paid. One interstate communication was reasonably foreseeable and furthered the agreement, as Serrano admitted during the plea hearing.

The final report preserves the distinction between participation and supervision. This conduct account supports guilt and the stipulated loss but does not, by itself, decide whether any exchange with Pared made Serrano her manager. The draft used broader relational wording; the final replaces it with neutral descriptions pending the court's ruling on the separate role recommendation.

Conviction Record and Statutory Consequences

Count One is the only count of conviction. Judge Venn accepted the plea after a personal Rule 11 inquiry and found a sufficient factual basis. Serrano acknowledged the statutory charge, trial rights, restitution exposure, advisory sentencing process, and the claim-specific appellate waiver. No count was dismissed as consideration for the plea.

The offense is punishable within the statutory ceiling applicable to conspiracy with a wire-fraud object. The court will state the final sentence, supervised-release term, assessment, and restitution obligation in its judgment. This packet recommends advisory treatment but cannot enlarge statutory authority or bind the court.

The plea agreement broadly waives conviction and sentencing appeals, including an ordinary Guidelines challenge, while expressly reserving a claim based on complete denial of personal allocution. The report records that term only as part of the conviction history. It does not predict a violation, decide enforceability, or convert a presentence category into legal advice.

Fact-Aster — Loss and Restitution Review

The parties stipulated that Meridian Community Supply Cooperative sustained \$186,400 in loss attributable to the fictional conspiracy. The final report uses that agreed sum for its restitution discussion. No party submitted a competing total during the presentence objection cycle, and no actual victim information exists.

The sealed exercise record does not list transactions or accounts. Fact-Aster groups the loss into harmless abstract claim categories solely to confirm that the total corresponds to the charged period. It omits timing patterns, submission sequences, validation weaknesses, and payment infrastructure. Such mechanics are unnecessary to sentencing and could turn a legal exercise into improper operational material.

The report recommends restitution of \$186,400, subject to the court's allocation, credits, and payment schedule. It also notes the \$100 special assessment. Financial-capacity information is represented only through Person-Fable, an inert profile that identifies no real asset, employer, dependent, or obligation. A later judgment will control the actual synthetic financial terms.

Participant Roster and Responsibility

The criminal activity involved exactly five criminally responsible people: Mateo Serrano, Alina Pared, Corin Bell, Darius Venn, and Nessa Holt. Each name is fictional. The report excludes unwitting cooperative personnel and investigators from the participant count because criminal responsibility, not contact with the matter, controls the numerical inquiry.

Serrano admitted knowing membership. The presentence dispute focuses only on his relationship with Pared. The report does not suggest that he led all five people or organized the entire conspiracy. Nor does it assign a managerial title based on money handling, record access, or activity coordination standing alone.

The draft and final agree on the roster. They differ only in the wording used to characterize certain interactions. After reviewing the defense objection and government response, Faye retained a recommendation that Serrano supervised Pared but marked the supporting inference as contested. Judge Venn must make the finding independently under the applicable burden at sentencing.

Legal Framework for Relative Role

Under the 2025 Guidelines Manual, § 3B1.1(b) provides a three-level increase if criminal activity involved five or more participants or was otherwise extensive and the defendant acted as a manager or supervisor. Here, the five-participant premise is admitted. The unresolved question is whether Serrano managed or supervised at least one other criminally responsible person.

The report does not rely on a theory that control of property, assets, or activity alone establishes the adjustment. It evaluates the claimed interpersonal relationship under Role-Beryl. The fictional United States bears the burden of supporting the adjustment by a preponderance of the evidence, and the court must resolve the objection on the sentencing record.

The plea agreement permits the government to advocate for the increase and Serrano to oppose it in district court. It separately places an ordinary appellate challenge to the resulting Guidelines calculation within the broad appeal waiver. This report offers no opinion about appellate enforcement and does not merge the role issue with the express allocution exception.

Role-Beryl — Aggravating-Role Recommendation

Role-Beryl collects the fictional relational facts relevant to Pared. The final report states that Serrano asked Pared to complete assigned portions of the shared work, followed up about completion, and corrected one departure from the group plan. The government views those exchanges as person-directed supervision. Serrano states that all participants divided tasks mutually and that his follow-up carried no authority to command Pared.

Faye recommends the three-level adjustment, reasoning that the exchanges more likely than not reflect management of Pared. The recommendation does not rest on Serrano's handling of funds or information. The defense objection remains unresolved because the same abstract communications can support the competing equal-coordination inference without additional context.

No actionable communication text appears. Role-Beryl is an inert label, not a person, password, account, or coded instruction. The court may hear argument and review the synthetic supporting record at sentencing. Until then, the recommendation is not a judicial finding and should not be described as an admitted plea fact.

Other Guideline Components

The final report applies the undisputed offense-level components reflected in the parties' sentencing estimates and credits acceptance of responsibility consistent with Serrano's timely plea. It identifies no obstruction and no adjustment based on conduct after the November 2 offense-completion date. The only contested component is the three-level role recommendation.

The report uses the 2025 Manual because the offense continued beyond November 1, 2025. Neither side asserts an ex post facto disadvantage requiring an earlier Manual as a whole. The current role provision requires management or supervision of a participant; the packet does not apply an obsolete property-only rationale.

Rather than enumerate nonessential calculation mechanics, this exercise preserves the agreed totals at the paired range page. The probation officer's task is to provide a coherent advisory recommendation, while Judge Venn retains the duty to calculate the range and consider all lawful sentencing factors. Acceptance of responsibility does not resolve Role-Beryl, and good-faith litigation of the objection is not inconsistent with the plea.

Criminal History — Person-Fable

The fictional record assigns Serrano criminal-history category I. Person-Fable contains no real case number, arrest, address, date of birth, or law-enforcement identifier. The exercise assumes no score-producing prior sentence and no other adjustment to the category.

Faye verified the category within the synthetic source set and reported no objection from either party. That agreement does not bind the court if a lawful correction appears, but no competing information is anticipated. The page remains sealed because it forms part of the presentence report and sits beside other personal-history categories.

The public twin says only that a criminal-history section exists and that the parties had estimated category I. It does not disclose the inert profile. This sealed page should likewise not be mistaken for a real background record. Its function is to support the fictional advisory ranges and demonstrate stable twin navigation without creating personal data that could identify or harm anyone.

Range-Cinder — Total Level and Advisory Range

With the recommended three-level Role-Beryl adjustment, the final report calculates total offense level 20. Combined with criminal-history category I, that produces an advisory imprisonment range of 33 to 41 months. If Judge Venn sustains Serrano's objection and removes the three levels, the corresponding total is 17 and the range is 24 to 30 months.

Range-Cinder is an inert label for this paired calculation. It does not conceal a real score or private identifier. The range is advisory, and the court may impose a lawful sentence after resolving objections and considering 18 U.S.C. § 3553(a). Neither the plea agreement nor the report guarantees a term.

The final retains both alternatives so the effect of the objection is transparent. The probation recommendation uses the higher range because it retains § 3B1.1(b), while the defense position uses the lower range. This report does not determine the appellate consequences of the waiver and does not decide whether the role inference would survive review if review were otherwise available.

Statutory Terms and Financial Recommendation

The packet identifies the lawful sentencing options associated with Count One and recommends a term consistent with Range-Cinder, followed by supervised release. It records the agreed restitution amount of \$186,400, the mandatory \$100 assessment, and no recommended punitive fine. The court remains responsible for every imposed term.

Person-Fable reflects limited fictional payment capacity but supplies no account, property, income source, dependent name, or employer. Faye recommends a schedule that can be adjusted by the court without disclosing private details. Restitution serves the agreed fictional loss; it is distinct from punishment and from the role determination.

Any condition of supervised release must appear in the public judgment or be stated at sentencing as required. This report does not create a hidden operative condition. It may offer confidential context for a lawful condition, but the controlling sentence is the one pronounced by Judge Venn and memorialized by the clerk. The public surrogate provides only category notice and cannot reveal the sealed financial profile.

Sentencing Considerations — Position-Echo

Position-Echo organizes the probation officer's assessment of the statutory sentencing factors. The report notes the seriousness of a knowing conspiracy, the stipulated loss, the five-participant structure, Serrano's acceptance of responsibility, the disputed role inference, and the need for a sentence sufficient but not greater than necessary.

The analysis also considers History-Dovetail, an inert collection of mitigation categories, without naming private people or institutions. Faye recognizes that a sentencing court may vary from the advisory range and that neither party's recommended term controls. The report does not treat the waiver as a reason to increase punishment.

The probation officer's assessment is advisory. Arden and Ives may present competing views, and Serrano retains his personal right to speak before sentence. This page does not predict how Judge Venn will balance the factors. It gives the court an organized synthetic record while protecting personal information and avoiding any operational description of the underlying offense.

Work and Community History — Person-Fable

Person-Fable records that Serrano has a fictional history of steady work and participation in ordinary community support. Specific employers, locations, supervisors, schedules, and third parties are omitted. The final report treats those categories as favorable background without assigning them a fixed sentencing weight.

The draft used generic placeholders pending verification. The final marks the synthetic categories verified through counsel-provided material. No document in the packet can be matched to a real person or organization. The exercise does not include letters containing addresses, telephone numbers, medical data, or signatures of outside supporters.

Faye notes that stable work and community connection may bear on history, characteristics, and post-sentence planning. They do not erase culpability or decide the role objection. The court may consider them together with the offense, acceptance, restitution, and other factors. The paired public page identifies only a community-and-employment category, preserving the distinction between public notice and confidential detail.

Treatment and Personal Circumstances — Person-Fable

This position records harmless synthetic treatment and personal-circumstance categories. Serrano is described as having engaged consistently with a fictional counseling program and as planning continued participation. No diagnosis, medication, provider, facility, account, or appointment detail is created. The report treats the progress as potential mitigation and reentry support.

The page also notes generalized family caregiving responsibility without naming or describing another person. Those responsibilities may inform the court's assessment but do not dictate a sentence. The packet avoids sensitive facts even within the sealed twin because realism does not require simulated private records.

Faye confirms that the categories were raised before sentencing and are not post hoc inventions. Arden may offer broader argument through the protected sentencing memorandum. Ives may respond without exposing private details publicly. The public surrogate identifies only the existence of a treatment-and-personal-history section and provides no basis to infer its contents.

History-Dovetail — Mitigation Record

History-Dovetail combines four synthetic themes: Serrano's remorse, consistent treatment participation, caregiving responsibility, and stable work. Arden reports that Serrano has prepared a personal statement addressing those subjects and accepts responsibility for the harm caused to Meridian Community Supply Cooperative. The report does not reproduce that statement.

Faye regards the themes as meaningfully mitigating but not dispositive. They support consideration of a sentence toward the lower portion of whichever advisory range Judge Venn finds applicable. The report cannot assess Serrano's personal presentation before sentencing because allocution has not yet occurred.

No private person's name or condition is disclosed. The inert label prevents the exercise from simulating raw personal records while still preserving the legal proposition that mitigation could support a lower term. The paired public page identifies only the category. Later counsel advocacy may refer to the themes at an abstract level, and the court must give Serrano the personal opportunity required by Rule 32 before imposing sentence.

Probation Recommendation — Position-Echo

Using offense level 20 and criminal-history category I, Faye recommends 36 months of imprisonment, three years of supervised release, restitution of \$186,400, the \$100 assessment, and no fine. The recommendation falls within Range-Cinder and accounts for both offense seriousness and History-Dovetail. It is wholly fictional and nonbinding.

If Judge Venn removes the role adjustment, the report recommends that the court reassess the sentence against the resulting 24-to-30-month range rather than carry forward the same term automatically. The packet offers no opinion about the merits of an appellate challenge because the plea agreement separately governs appellate rights.

The recommendation assumes that the court will comply with all Rule 32 procedures, including resolving objections, allowing counsel to speak, and personally addressing Serrano. It does not state what Serrano will say or how the court will respond. A recommendation is not a judgment, and this page cannot supply an imposed sentence before the public sentencing proceeding.

Objection Cycle and Unresolved Issue

Arden timely objected on January 23 to Role-Beryl, contending that the abstract exchanges with Pared showed coordination rather than supervision. Faye answered on January 30 that the draft recommendation would remain pending the government's response. Ives responded on February 6 and supported the adjustment. The final retains it as unresolved.

No party objected to the five-participant count, offense-completion date, category I premise, stipulated loss, or acceptance treatment. Those nonobjections do not transform every report statement into a plea admission. Judge Venn must determine the contested role issue and may correct any other material error identified at sentencing.

The packet was served through fictional authorized channels outside public access. No discretionary sealing motion or new sealing order was required for the report and its responses under the then-effective local rules. The separately indexed objection packet preserves the detailed submissions. This page records the process sufficiently for the court while keeping the present report confidential.

Final Certification and Access Boundary

Niko Faye certifies that this twenty-page final packet, incorporating the January 9 draft lineage, is complete for the synthetic presentence exercise as of February 17, 2026. The report remains confidential and paired with a twenty-page public docket surrogate. The public twin contains categories and dates only, not redacted report text.

The stable correspondence assigns one logical subject to each equal page. Named positions cover Fact-Aster offense conduct, Role-Beryl role analysis, Range-Cinder calculation, and History-Dovetail mitigation. The remaining pages receive unique stable subjects. Any later protected citation must use the logical subject rather than a raw sealed-page identifier.

Within the fictional workbench, a disclosure-specific grant tied to exact pack identity may temporarily expose this sealed twin after independent CAS path, size, digest, readability, and page-count checks. Revocation must remove it and restore the public surrogate. This software projection makes no claim about real court or probation access. No real PSR was used or created.

Niko Faye Fictional Probation Officer